

1. Purpose

The Activity log is a platform log in Azure that provides insight into subscription-level events. It includes such information as when a resource is modified or when a virtual machine is started. The information provided is invaluable when trying to determine what has been happening in the environment; however, the data is only retained in Azure for 90 days.

This document provides the process to send the data to an Azure Log Analytics Workspace for long term storage and analytics.

Note: There is a cost associated with log analytics which will be added to the customer's subscription.

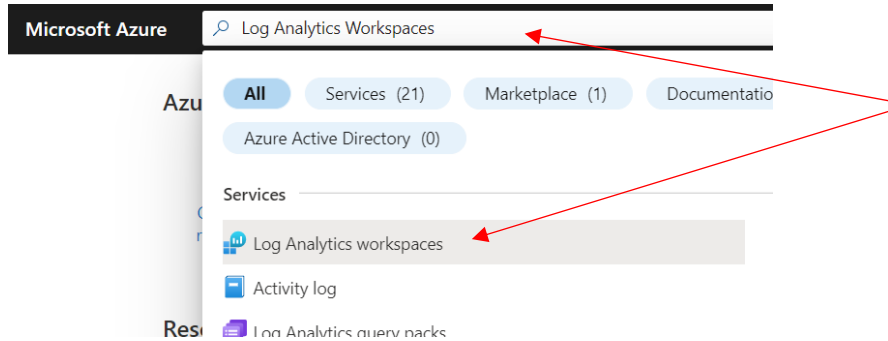
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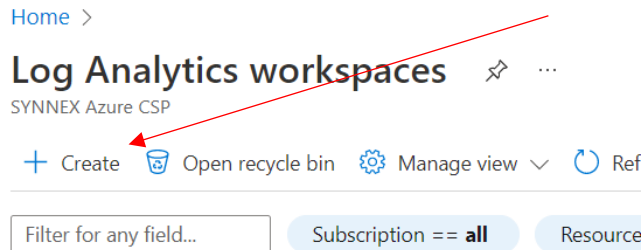
3. Procedure

3.1. Create the Log Analytics Workspace

1. Log into the [Azure Portal](#)
2. Navigate to Log Analytics Workspaces by searching in the search bar



3. Then click on Log Analytics workspaces in the list
4. Click on Create to create a new workspace



5. Select the subscription, resource group and region. Give the workspace a descriptive name. Then click Review + Create

Home > Log Analytics workspaces >

Create Log Analytics workspace

Project details
Select the subscription to manage deployed resources and costs. Use resource groups like folders to organize and manage all your resources.

Subscription *

Resource group * [Create new](#)

Instance details

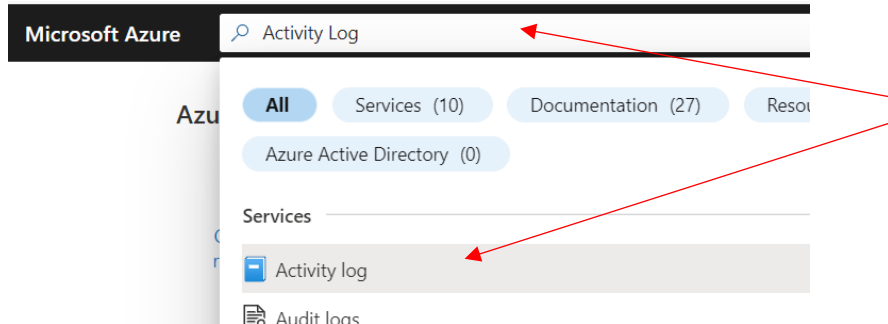
Name *

Region *

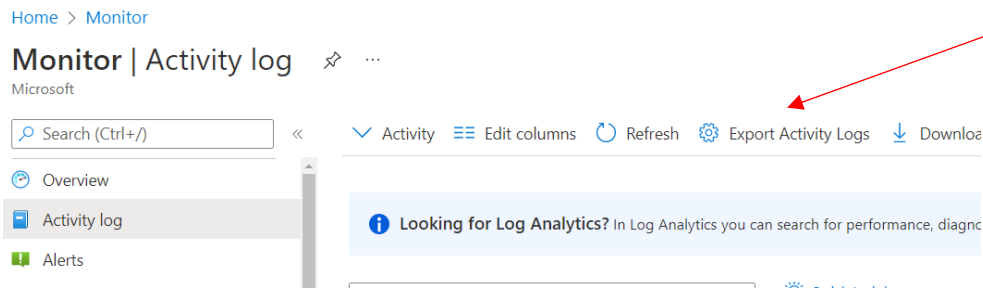
[Review + Create](#) [Previous](#) [Next: Tags >](#)

3.2. Send Activity Log to the Log Analytics Workspace

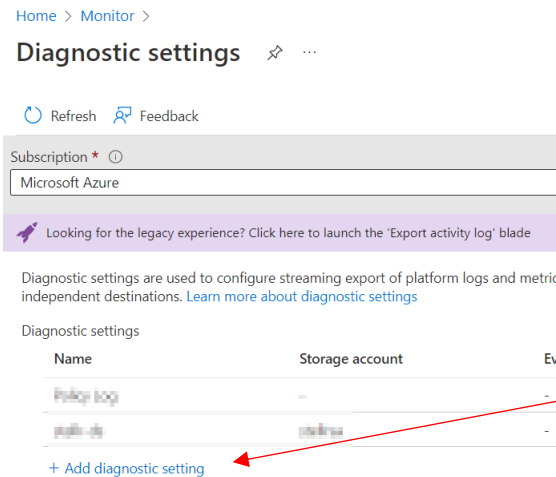
1. Navigate to Activity Log by searching in the search bar



2. Then click on Activity Log in the list
3. Click on Export Activity Logs from the top menu



4. Click on the +Add diagnostic settings link



5. Give the setting a descriptive name, select the Log Analytics workspace, and choose the logs to send. At a minimum you should select Administrative, Security and Alert; however, consider sending all logs.

[Home](#) > [Monitor](#) > [Diagnostic settings](#) >

Diagnostic setting ...

 Save  Discard  Delete  Feedback

[categories and contents of those logs](#)

Diagnostic setting name *

ds-ActivityLogs

Logs

Categories

☒ Administrative

☒ Security

☐ ServiceHealth

☒ Alert

☐ Recommendation

Destination details

☒ Send to Log Analytics workspace

Subscription

Microsoft Azure

Log Analytics workspace

law-ActivityLogs (eastus)

☐ Archive to a storage account

6. Click Save to save the settings.
7. Activity logs will now be copied to the Log Analytics Workspace. You may query them by navigating to the workspace.

3.3. Consider Sending Other Logs to the Log Analytics Workspace

1. Logs from many services in Azure may be sent to log analytics by selecting diagnostic settings from the Monitoring menu in the resources blade.

Monitoring

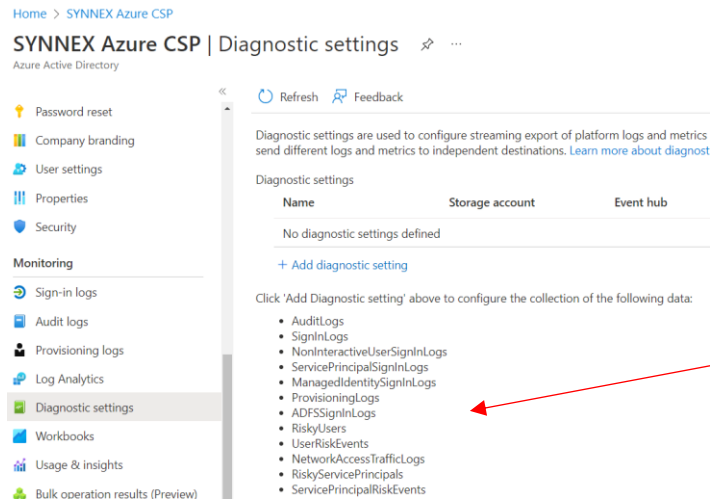
 Insights

 Alerts

 Metrics

 Diagnostic settings

2. Besides the Activity Logs, we recommend sending all Azure Active Directory logs to the log analytics workspace.



3. For security logs, also consider sending the logs to Sentinel or another SEIM solution.

3.4. Optimizing and Using the Logs

1. You will want to gain an understanding of the Kusto Query Language to get the most use of logging data.
2. Review the setting in the Log Analytics Workspace to optimize the operation of the service and set retention policies.
3. Microsoft and TD Synnex have training resources available to assist you. Contact your TD Synnex Account Manager for more information.

4. Associated Documents

- [Azure Activity log - Azure Monitor | Microsoft Docs](#)
- [Configure data retention and archive in Azure Monitor Logs \(Preview\) - Azure Monitor | Microsoft Docs](#)
- [How long does Azure AD store reporting data? | Microsoft Docs](#)

5. Document Approval

This document has been approved by:

- Manager, Cloud Sales Engineering

6. Document Revision History

Number	Effective Date	Revision History	Author
1.0	5/23/2022	Initial Draft	David Bloom